

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Development Programme (UNDP)
Regional Hub for Latin America and the Caribbean**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Panama City, Panama
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Inclusive Growth

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Rita Sciarra
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Inclusive Growth Team Leader
<u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>	Ms. Sara Luaces
<u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u>	Regional Policy specialist

3. Background information

The UNDP Regional Hub for Latin America and the Caribbean (RHLAC) serves as the region's main platform for providing strategic policy advice, technical assistance, and knowledge management to support the implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) at both national and subnational levels. The Hub supports country offices and governments in aligning national priorities with regional and global development frameworks, fostering coordination among key actors to ensure coherence, impact, and sustainability.

The Hub's drives a development agenda focused on resilience, inclusion, and sustainability. Its strategic lines include strengthening MSMEs through resilient technical assistance, promoting gender equality as a driver of productivity and social cohesion, and supporting productive transformation processes aligned with climate and biodiversity goals. Its operating model is based on co-creation and technical accompaniment to country offices, aligning regional responses with national demands and connecting with global teams through platforms such as the Global Policy Network (GPN). Through the Regional Collaboration Platform, the Centre coordinates thematic coalitions on climate change, crime and violence, equitable growth, governance and institutions, and human mobility, offering regional public goods and technical support to countries to advance the 2030 Agenda.

Within the Inclusive Growth - Prosperity For All, the Hub implements a portfolio of programmes aimed at promoting inclusive and sustainable economic development. This includes the Inclusive Value Chain Programme, which works to strengthen micro, small, and medium-sized enterprises (MSMEs) through value chain integration, innovation, and access to finance. MSMEs represent 99.5% of all businesses in the region, employ around 60% of the workforce, and contribute approximately 25% of GDP. However,

To address these challenges, UNDP applies inclusive business methodologies such as In Motion (En Marcha), the Supplier Development Programme (Programa de Desarrollo de Proveedores), Starting with Your Business (Iniciando con su Negocio), and Growing with your Business (Creciendo con su Negocio). These approaches support enterprises throughout their growth journey—from diagnostics and capacity-building to market linkages and financing.

The Inclusive Value Chain Program has achieved significant success, being implemented in 16 country offices and reaching over 40,000 SMEs. Recently, an Impact Measurement and Management (IMM) module was added. Through the SDG Value Chain program, UNDP provides a suite of tools and evidence-based methodologies that are critical for developing pipelines of high-potential MSMEs.

The Fellow will contribute to this dynamic environment, engaging in initiatives that combine policy analysis, programme implementation, and knowledge sharing, while gaining exposure to regional coordination mechanisms and innovative approaches for SDG acceleration

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will support the Inclusive Growth team. The assignment will provide exposure to regional programmes on inclusive and sustainable business and value chains, focusing on strengthening the capacities of country offices and national institutions to promote private sector engagement and SME development aligned with the SDGs.

The Fellow will contribute to the following key functions:

- Support the transfer and appropriation of inclusive business methodologies to UNDP Country Offices and public institutions, in line with the Strategic Plan and Regional Programme Document.
- Assist in the review, update, and adaptation of UNDP's inclusive business tools and methodologies, incorporating inputs from country offices and thematic clusters.
- Contribute to monitoring and evaluation activities, helping to assess results and impact of inclusive business methodologies implemented across the region.
- Foster articulation and collaboration among projects at national and regional levels to enhance synergies and maximize results.
- Support knowledge management and communication efforts, including the systematization and dissemination of good practices and the maintenance of the Programme's global dashboard and web content.

- Facilitate the replication of successful private sector experiences, such as those of Lavazza and Illy Caffè, leveraging their inclusive and sustainable value chain approaches to promote responsible sourcing, fair trade, and local supplier integration.
- Contribute to the preparation of concept notes and partnership proposals on inclusive economic development, aimed at mobilizing resources and engaging with the private sector.
- Assist with administrative and coordination tasks related to the Inclusive Value Chains Programme and other regional initiatives.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

Advanced university degree (Master's level or equivalent) in Development Studies, Social Sciences, Economics, Economic Sciences, or other related fields relevant to inclusive and sustainable development.

Work experience

Candidates are expected to have one year of relevant professional or academic experience in the fields of inclusive and sustainable development, private sector engagement, or economic development.

Experience may include:

- Contributing to the design, monitoring, or coordination of projects within international or development organizations.
- Participating in initiatives related to SME development, inclusive business models, innovation, or value chain strengthening.
- Engaging in projects that involve the creation of partnerships between the public and private sector
- Previous experience within the United Nations System and/or other development organizations in areas such as financial inclusion, economic recovery, sustainable development, poverty reduction, or micro and small enterprise development will be considered an asset.

Languages

Demonstrable fluency in English and Spanish, both written and oral is required.

Command of Portuguese and/or French an asset.

Other skills

- Advanced proficiency in Microsoft Office 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams).
- Familiarity with AI tools such as Microsoft Copilot for analysis and drafting.
- Basic skills in data visualization (advanced Excel, Power BI, Stata, R).
- Clear and effective writing for reports, presentations, and newsletters.
- Ability to quickly learn new digital tools and adapt to virtual environments.

Competencies

Achieve Results:	LEVEL 1: Plans and monitors own work, pays attention to details, delivers quality work by deadline
Think Innovatively:	LEVEL 1: Open to creative ideas/known risks, is a pragmatic problem-solver, makes improvements
Learn Continuously	LEVEL 1: Open-minded and curious, shares knowledge, learns from mistakes, asks for feedback

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment, the Fellow will be able to:

- Develop and manage knowledge products, including reports, infographics, and communication materials, ensuring systematic information sharing and visibility of results.
- Apply knowledge management techniques, such as maintaining internal platforms (e.g., intranet pages) and organizing data for regional coordination and learning.

- Draft and review project proposals tailored to country office contexts and aligned with inclusive and sustainable business priorities.
- Use data collection, statistical analysis, and data visualization tools to monitor programme implementation and assess results at the regional level.
- Organize and facilitate online workshops and webinars, strengthening capacities of country office teams and partners.
- Provide administrative and coordination support for regional initiatives, improving planning and operational management skills.
- Understand the regional architecture and programme cycle of UNDP, gaining practical insight into the design, monitoring, and evaluation of inclusive business and private sector development initiatives.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

The Fellow will work under the direct supervision of the Inclusive Growth team within the Inclusive Value Chains Programme at the UNDP Regional Hub for Latin America and the Caribbean.

At the outset of the assignment, the supervisor will provide a comprehensive briefing covering the office's structure, ongoing initiatives, and the fellow's specific responsibilities. Together, they will co-develop a work plan detailing key deliverable, timelines, and learning objectives.

Supervision will be conducted through regular meetings (weekly or biweekly), which will serve to monitor progress, provide technical guidance, and ensure alignment with programme priorities. The fellow will also be encouraged to participate in team meetings and cross-cluster exchanges to gain exposure to the Regional Hub's integrated programming approach.

Progress will be tracked through periodic check-ins and reporting mechanisms, allowing space for feedback, reflection, and adjustment of tasks in response to evolving programme needs. A final review meeting will be held at the end of the assignment to assess the fellow's contributions, achievements, and learning outcomes.

The supervision approach will emphasize learning-by-doing, mentorship, and continuous feedback to foster both effective performance and professional development within the UNDP conte

8. Living conditions in the country

Panama offers a dynamic and welcoming environment for international fellows, combining modern infrastructure with rich cultural diversity and natural beauty. As the regional hub for trade and logistics in Latin America, Panama City provides access to reliable public services, high-speed internet, and a wide range of housing options, from modest apartments to fully serviced residences.

The cost of living in Panama is relatively affordable compared to other countries in the region. Fellows can expect to cover basic monthly expenses—including rent, utilities, transportation, and food—with

approximately USD 1,100 to USD 1,300, depending on lifestyle and location. While Panama City is more expensive, smaller towns such as Boquete or Pedasí offer lower costs and a quieter pace of life. ¹

Panama enjoys a tropical climate with a dry season from late December to March and a rainy season from May to mid-December. Year-round sunshine and proximity to beaches, mountains, and rainforests support an active outdoor lifestyle.

Healthcare services are widely available, especially in urban centers, and international fellows typically access private clinics for routine care. Safety conditions are generally favorable, though caution is advised in certain neighborhoods of Panama City and remote border areas. ²

Panama's multicultural society and strong expat presence foster an inclusive atmosphere. Fellows will find it easy to integrate into local communities and professional networks, particularly within the UN system and development sector. The country's use of the US dollar and its stable economy further contribute to a smooth transition for international professionals.

¹ <https://www.globalcitizensolutions.com/living-in-panama/>

² <https://www.foyerglobalhealth.com/destination/living-as-an-expat-in-panama-our-key-tips-for-a-successful-move/>